

SHEET UX-01 CROSS ANGLE INTERIOR REVIEWED 10 SEP 2026
BRANCH FEATURE/DAM-V3-MILESTONE-PLANNING BUILD LOCALHOST:8080

Cross Angle UX Snag List

A defect register for the public site, taken against a running build at 1440×900 and 375×812. Eighteen entries, ordered by what they cost you in enquiries. Four of them are structural and undo a large amount of the design work already paid for.

4	6	6	2
P0 · CRITICAL	P1 · HIGH	P2 · MEDIUM	P3 · LOW
480	18.6		
DEAD TOKEN REFS	MOBILE SCREENS, /PORTFOLIO		

01 Executive summary

Cross Angle has the raw material of a genuinely premium site. The editorial instinct is right: asymmetric composition, restraint, long dissolves, photography given room. Someone with taste designed this. The problem is that a large part of that design is not reaching the browser, and what does reach it is arranged to hide the work rather than sell it.

Three findings dominate. First, the semantic design-token layer described in CLAUDE.md is **never imported** — 480 references to `var(--s-*)` across 37 components resolve to nothing. On the contact page this renders seventeen elements with **pure white 1px borders** instead of near-invisible hairlines; on the homepage the signature reveal curtain is fully transparent, so the cinematic entrance does nothing at all. Second, every project card in the archive is served `grayscale(1) brightness(0.75)`

and only recovers colour on hover — so on phones, where most of your enquiries will originate, the entire body of work is presented desaturated and dimmed. Third, the homepage's only hero call to action sits underneath the cookie panel at a common desktop size.

None of these are taste disagreements. They are wiring faults, and the fix for each is small relative to its effect. Underneath them sits a fourth, softer problem: the site is very long and very quiet. The homepage runs 4.6 screens and shows two photographs of finished work, no services, no testimonial, no price signal, and no contact block. The portfolio runs 18.6 screens on a phone to present five projects. A prospective client arrives wanting to see rooms and leaves having mostly seen empty dark space and 10px labels.

02 Method, and what this audit cannot tell you

What I did. Read the public route tree and page sources, then drove the running dev build in a real browser at desktop (1440×900) and mobile (375×812) emulation. Every measurement quoted — element rectangles, computed colours, filters, document heights, contrast ratios, occurrence counts — was taken from that live build or from `grep` over `apps/web/src`, and is reproducible.

What I do not have. No analytics, no session recordings, no heatmaps, no enquiry-rate data, no user testing, and no interviews with past clients. I have therefore invented none. Where I claim a business effect I am reasoning from established usability principles and from the mechanics of the funnel as built, and I have labelled the confidence on every entry. Anything marked *Speculative* should be treated as a hypothesis to test, not a finding. The single highest-value thing you could add to this document is a fortnight of PostHog funnel data on `/ → /portfolio → /contact-us`; the instrumentation is already in the codebase.

03 Overall assessment

The site currently reads as *expensively art-directed but under-built*. The visual language is coherent and adult — near-black ground, a single gold accent at `#C9A85C`, a display serif set tight at `-0.03em`, generous negative space. That accent measures 9.24:1 against the ground, so the gold is doing its job legibly, which is more than most studios manage. The engineering discipline in places is genuinely good: the contact form is one of the better-built lead forms I have reviewed.

But premium is not only atmosphere; it is *confidence*. A luxury studio's site should feel certain about what it does, show a great deal of proof quickly, and make contact trivially easy. This one withholds. It defers the work behind long scroll gaps, greys the photography out, hides the gallery from the main navigation, points a “View Case Study” link at an index page rather than a case study, and gives a phone user no way to call or message without scrolling back to the top and opening a menu. The restraint has tipped into evasiveness.

Fix the four P0 entries and the site jumps a tier without a redesign. The P1s are where the commercial upside sits.

04 Strengths worth preserving

- **The contact form is properly built.** Every input has an associated `<label>`, correct autocomplete tokens (`given-name`, `family-name`, `email`, `tel-national`), 48px targets, `aria-invalid` wired to error text, and on failed submit it returns to the offending step and focuses the first invalid field. Do not let a redesign regress this.
- **Reduced motion is respected across the board**, not as an afterthought — `useReducedMotion` in components, `motion-reduce`: utilities on transitions, a `prefers-reduced-motion` guard inside the hero's own keyframes, and even scroll behaviour switching from `smooth` to `auto`. Given how motion-heavy the site is, this matters.
- **The navbar's keyboard behaviour is correct:** a skip link, a real focus trap on the mobile menu with Escape to close, `aria-expanded` on the toggle, and a 48px hit area.

- **The global focus style is right** — `:focus-visible { outline: 2px solid }` with offset. It is the components that override it that are the problem, not the baseline.
- **Alt text discipline holds.** Zero images on the homepage lacked alt text, and archive cards compose it from real data (`"{title} - {category} interior showcase"`).
- **Structured data is unusually thorough** — LocalBusiness, Organization, WebSite, Service and FAQPage on the homepage alone, with real address, geo and service areas. Good AEO groundwork.
- **The gallery's saved-boards feature is a genuinely good idea:** visitors can save looks and share a board by URL, and the contact form pre-fills a message when arriving with an `?interest=` parameter. That is a real conversion mechanic. It is under-exploited, not wrong.

05 Critical defects

CA-01 P0

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

The semantic token layer is never imported, so 480 colour references resolve to nothing

OBSERVATION	<code>tokens/index.css</code> imports <code>./semantic.css</code> and <code>./foundation.css</code> — a 16-line and a 25-line legacy pair defining <code>--canvas-primary</code> and <code>--text-primary</code> . The documented three-layer system lives in <code>tokens/semantic/semantic.css</code> (43 lines) and <code>tokens/foundation/colors.css</code> (74 lines), defining <code>--s-*</code> and <code>--m-*</code> . Those directories are never imported.
EVIDENCE	Live: <code>getComputedStyle(:root)</code> returns <code>""</code> for <code>--s-canvas-primary</code> , <code>--s-text-primary</code> , <code>--s-border-subtle</code> , <code>--m-wall</code> and <code>--m-detail</code> , while <code>--canvas-primary</code> returns <code>0 0% 4%</code> . Blast radius: 480 <code>var(--s-*)</code> occurrences across 37 <code>.tsx</code> files, of which 144 are <code>--s-border-subtle</code> , 99 <code>--s-text-primary</code> , 60 <code>--s-canvas-primary</code> .
WHAT BREAKS	An invalid <code>border-color</code> falls back to <code>currentColor</code> . On <code>/contact-us</code> , all 17 elements using <code>border-[var(--s-border-subtle)]</code> compute to <code>rgb(255,255,255)</code> — seventeen stark white outlines on a near-black page, where hairlines were intended. The

homepage reveal curtain computes `background: rgba(0,0,0,0)` , so the signature entrance animation is invisible. Text that reads correctly does so by *inheritance*, not by token — it is accidental.

USER IMPACT

The most conversion-critical page in the funnel looks cheap and unfinished at exactly the moment trust is being asked for. Elsewhere the effect is silent, which is worse: the design system cannot be relied on, and any future theming work is building on nothing.

BUSINESS IMPACT

Direct. Visual credibility on the enquiry page is the last thing a high-value client evaluates before filling in a form.

FIX

Point `tokens/index.css` at `./semantic/semantic.css` , `./foundation/colors.css` , `./materials/materials.css` and `./environments/environments.css` , then delete the two legacy shadow files so the ambiguity cannot recur. Expect visual shifts everywhere the fallback was flattering — budget a full visual pass, and tag a `checkpoint/` before starting, per the repo's own convention. Add a build assertion that fails if any `--s-*` used in source is undefined at runtime.

CA-02 P0

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

Every project in the archive is greyscale and dimmed on touch devices

OBSERVATION

`ProjectArchiveCard.tsx` sets `grayscale brightness-75` with colour restored only via `group-hover: .` At 375px, all archive images compute `filter: brightness(0.75) grayscale(1)` .

EVIDENCE

Touch devices have no hover state; a tap on the card navigates. There is no touch fallback, no `@media (hover: none) override`, and no intersection-based reveal. Mobile visitors therefore see the complete body of work permanently desaturated at 75% brightness.

USER IMPACT

Colour, material and light *are* the product of an interior studio. Presenting them in grey removes the single strongest reason to enquire. A visitor cannot judge whether they like your palette, because you have removed it.

BUSINESS IMPACT

Severe on the surface most likely to precede an enquiry. Established principle: for visual-first services, image fidelity is the primary persuasion channel.

FIX

Show projects in full colour by default. If the desaturated grid is deliberate art direction, invert the interaction — full colour at rest,

a subtle dim on *sibling* cards during hover, which reads as focus rather than suppression — and gate any greyscale behind @media (hover: hover) so touch never sees it. Same fix applies to brightness-75 .

CA-03 P0

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

The cookie panel covers the homepage's only hero call to action

- OBSERVATION

At 1440×900 the consent panel occupies x 20–360, y 678–880. The hero's “View Portfolio” button occupies x 96–294, y 741–791. It is completely enclosed.
- EVIDENCE

Measured via getBoundingClientRect() on the live build. The hero content is bottom-anchored (justify-end) and the panel is bottom-left anchored, so the collision is structural, not incidental — it will occur at most desktop heights.
- USER IMPACT

The first and most prominent action on the site is unclickable until consent is dismissed. Visitors who ignore cookie banners — most of them — simply scroll past, and the next portfolio link is 1,900px further down.
- BUSINESS IMPACT

Direct loss at the top of the funnel, affecting every first-time desktop visitor.
- FIX

Move the consent panel to a full-width bottom bar, or anchor it bottom-right and add matching bottom padding to the hero content while it is open. Cheapest correct version: render the banner in a bottom sheet that reserves its own layout space rather than overlaying.

CA-04 P0

CONFIDENCE · LIKELY

Mobile visitors have no persistent way to make contact

- OBSERVATION

FixedSocialBar — which carries the WhatsApp and phone affordances — is hidden md:flex . Across the site the only fixed bottom elements are the cookie banner, toasts, and one service detail page.
- EVIDENCE

The portfolio page measures 15,132px on a 375×812 viewport — 18.6 full screens. A visitor who reaches the bottom must scroll all the way back, open the hamburger, and tap Contact: three

	deliberate actions after an 18-screen commitment.
USER IMPACT	Intent decays with every step. The moment of highest intent is immediately after seeing a project they like — and at that moment there is nothing to tap.
BUSINESS IMPACT	High. In this category most traffic and most first contact is mobile, and WhatsApp is the dominant enquiry channel in the Jamshedpur market the site targets.
FIX	Add a persistent mobile action bar — WhatsApp and Call, two 56px targets, appearing after roughly one viewport of scroll and hiding while the contact form is on screen. Reuse the existing <code>settings.whatsapp</code> value so it stays CMS-controlled.

06 Journey analysis

Six journeys, walked end to end on the running build.

JOURNEY	VERDICT	WHERE IT FAILS
Homepage → project discovery	Weak	Hero CTA occluded (CA-03). The featured project is <i>hardcoded</i> — “The Highland Residence”, a static <code>/public</code> PNG — and its “View Case Study” link points to <code>/portfolio</code> , the index, not a case study. The promise and the destination do not match.
Homepage → services → enquiry	Broken	The homepage contains no services content of any kind . The only route to services is the top navigation. A visitor who scrolls the homepage never learns what Cross Angle sells, at what scale, or at what price.
Portfolio → project → enquiry	Weak	The strongest journey structurally — archive cards link correctly to <code>/portfolio/:slug</code> , and the detail page carries related projects and a WhatsApp affordance. Undermined by CA-02 (greyscale) and by only five projects in the archive.
Gallery → project exploration	Broken	Gallery items are mapped with <code>slug: undefined</code> — hardcoded, not a data gap. No gallery image can ever link to the project it came from . The lightbox accepts a slug it will never receive. The journey dead-ends by construction.

Blog → brand discovery → enquiry	Adequate	Best-served journey: an in-article lead CTA, a sidebar CTA, a consultation link and prev/next navigation. The gap is upstream — nothing routes a reader from an article toward the portfolio.
Mobile → portfolio → contact	Broken	18.6 screens of scroll, all work shown in greyscale, no persistent contact affordance, 38 sub-44px touch targets, and 104 of 242 text nodes rendering below 12px.

The gallery is signposted, then not delivered

Worth isolating, because it is a self-inflicted contradiction. The homepage's closing section is headed “Explore the Gallery” under the eyebrow “The Archive”. Its button reads “Enter Portfolio” and links to /portfolio . Meanwhile /gallery — a genuinely better browsing experience, with CMS-driven categories, live counts, a lightbox and saveable boards — is absent from navLinks entirely and appears only in the footer. You have built the better discovery surface and then hidden it, while pointing a link labelled “Gallery” somewhere else.

07 Visual and UI consistency

CA-05	P1	CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN
The homepage is 4.6 screens long and shows two photographs of finished work		
OBSERVATION	Document height 4,149px at 900px viewport. Content blocks: hero (855px), philosophy headline (415px), a copy panel (299px), one featured project (512px), a gallery invitation (552px). The footer occupies 976px — 23% of the page, and larger than any content section. Inter-section gaps run 144–162px of empty ground.	
EVIDENCE	Measured from the live DOM. Two images of work total: the hero and one featured project. No services, no process, no testimonial, no credentials, no pricing signal, no contact block.	
USER IMPACT	A first-time visitor scrolls nearly five screens and learns the studio's philosophy, sees one room, and is offered a style quiz. The questions that actually precede an enquiry — what do you do, have	

you done it well before, what does it cost, who else trusted you — go unanswered.

BUSINESS
IMPACT

High. The homepage is doing brand work and no sales work.

FIX

Keep the restraint but raise the density of proof. Between the philosophy line and the closing CTA, add: a three-up services strip with real price bands; a four-to-six project mosaic drawn from the CMS rather than one hardcoded project; and one client testimonial with a name, a locality and the project it refers to. Tighten inter-section gaps from ~160px to ~96px and cut the footer to roughly half its height.

CA-06 P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

10px uppercase is the site's default label size — 884 times

OBSERVATION `text-[9px]` and `text-[10px]` appear **884 times across 195 files**. Nearly every eyebrow, chip, filter, and button label — including primary CTAs like “View Portfolio” and “Take Style Quiz” — is set at 10px uppercase with 0.2em tracking.

EVIDENCE On mobile, 104 of 242 measured text nodes on `/portfolio` render below 12px — 43% of the page's text.

USER IMPACT Tiny tracked uppercase is a legitimate luxury signal in *small doses*. At this frequency it stops reading as refinement and starts reading as strain, particularly for the 45–65 age band that commissions high-value interiors.

BUSINESS
IMPACT Moderate but broad — it taxes every interaction on the site.

FIX Introduce two label tokens and migrate to them: `--label-sm` at 11px for genuine micro-annotations, and `--label` at 13px for anything a user is expected to *act* on. Primary CTAs should not be smaller than the body text they sit beside.

CA-07 P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

The brand name renders three different ways, and the page title flickers between two

OBSERVATION The navbar wordmark reads **CROSSANGLE INTERIOR**; the schema markup and most page copy say **Cross Angle Interior**. On load, the

	document title visibly changes from “Cross Angle Interior Luxury Interior Design Studio” to “Crossangle Interior Premium Interior Design Studio” as a second Helmet block mounts.
EVIDENCE	Observed across repeated navigations. Additionally every audited page renders two <code><h1></code> elements — an <code>sr-only</code> duplicate of the page title plus the visible headline.
USER IMPACT	Minor per instance; corrosive in aggregate. Inconsistent naming is one of the fastest ways a premium brand reads as improvised. Screen-reader users hear the page title twice.
BUSINESS IMPACT	Brand equity and search consistency — “Crossangle” and “Cross Angle” compete as query targets.
FIX	Pick one written form, put it in <code>SITE_CONSTANTS</code> , and use it everywhere including the wordmark. Resolve the duplicate Helmet titles. Delete the <code>sr-only</code> <code>h1</code> on pages that already have a visible one.

CA-08	P3	CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN
Gallery page is missing its meta description, canonical and OG tags		
OBSERVATION	GalleryPage.tsx renders only <code><title></code> , while every comparable page carries description, canonical and Open Graph tags.	
USER IMPACT	Shared gallery links render without a preview card — and the gallery's board-sharing feature exists specifically to be shared.	
BUSINESS IMPACT	Low but easy: a shared inspiration board is a warm referral, and it currently arrives looking broken.	
FIX	Mirror the Helmet block from <code>PortfolioPage.tsx</code> . The crawler middleware already injects dynamic OG data for <code>/blog/:slug</code> and <code>/portfolio/:slug</code> ; extend it to gallery boards.	

08 Portfolio and gallery

CA-09	P1	CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN
Editorial prominence is assigned by list position, not by project quality		

OBSERVATION	ProjectArchive.tsx computes each card's bento size as <code>patterns[index % 6]</code> . The first project always gets the 2×2 hero tile; the third, fourth and sixth always get 240px thumbnails.
EVIDENCE	Purely positional — no <code>featured</code> , <code>weight</code> or <code>display_priority</code> field participates.
USER IMPACT	Visual hierarchy is the strongest editorial signal you have, and it is currently random with respect to merit. Reordering in the CMS silently reassigns which project looks most important.
BUSINESS IMPACT	Meaningful: your best work may be rendering at 240px while a weaker project fills the hero tile.
FIX	Drive the span from a CMS field — a <code>tile_size</code> enum (<code>hero / tall / standard</code>) on the project record — and fall back to the index pattern only when unset. Surface it in the admin CMS so the studio controls its own hierarchy.

CA-10 P1

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

Portfolio filters are hardcoded; the gallery's are CMS-driven

OBSERVATION	Portfolio: <code>const categories = ["All", "Residential", "Commercial", "Hospitality", "Workspace", "Retail"]</code> . Gallery: categories derived from <code>useGalleryCategories()</code> , with live counts per tab.
EVIDENCE	Two discovery surfaces, two incompatible models. Add a project in a new category via the CMS and no tab appears for it; a category with no projects still shows a tab that leads to the empty state “ <i>Collection curation in progress.</i> ” — which offers no way back to All.
USER IMPACT	Filters that lead nowhere, and work that is invisible because its category has no tab.
BUSINESS IMPACT	The CMS cannot be trusted to publish work correctly — every new category needs a developer.
FIX	Derive portfolio categories from the project data, adopt the gallery's per-tab counts, hide zero-count tabs, and give the empty state a “Show all projects” action.

CA-11 P1

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

The gallery separates images with 30vh of empty space

The gallery separates images with too much empty space

OBSERVATION	The gallery grid uses <code>gap-[30vh]</code> <code>inside</code> <code>mt-[15vh]</code> <code>mb-[30vh]</code> . At an 812px phone that is ~244px of nothing between image groups; on desktop, ~270px.
USER IMPACT	Browsing inspiration is a high-frequency, low-commitment behaviour — users want density and momentum. Cinematic pacing is right for a case study and wrong for an archive.
BUSINESS IMPACT	Fewer images seen per session, and the saved-boards feature depends on volume of images seen.
FIX	Reduce to a 32–48px gutter and let the images carry the rhythm. Reserve the cinematic spacing for the featured-story sections on <code>/portfolio</code> , where narrative pacing earns it. Replace the bare <i>“Loading...”</i> string with the skeleton components the project already ships.

CA-12 P2

CONFIDENCE · LIKELY

Five projects is thin proof for a premium positioning

OBSERVATION	The live archive returns five projects, of which three are re-used as featured stories higher on the same page.
EVIDENCE	Counted from the rendered archive. I cannot tell whether this reflects the studio's actual output or an incomplete CMS — that is a content question, not a code one.
USER IMPACT	A visitor scrolling 18 screens to find five projects, three already seen, concludes the studio is small or new.
BUSINESS IMPACT	High-value clients de-risk by volume of comparable prior work.
FIX	Content, not code: publish every completed project, even briefly documented. Twelve projects with three photographs each beats five with fifteen. If five is genuinely the catalogue, restructure the page around depth — process, materials, before/after — rather than breadth.

CA-13 P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

The homepage CTA looks like two controls but is one link

OBSERVATION	The primary homepage CTA is a single full-width <code><Link></code> with <code>justify-between</code> , rendering “TAKE STYLE QUIZ” hard left and “EXPLORE →” hard right, separated by roughly 400px of empty space with a rule above.
USER IMPACT	It reads as a label and a separate button. Users aim for “EXPLORE”, and the large dead centre gives no hover feedback that the whole row is live. Two labels for one destination is also two chances to misread where it goes.
BUSINESS IMPACT	This is the homepage's principal conversion control, pointing at the discovery quiz — the site's best lead-qualification asset.
FIX	Make it one bounded button with a single label: “ Take the style quiz → ”, 13px minimum, with a visible hover fill across the whole target. Say what happens next — “six questions, about two minutes” — underneath.

CA-14 P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

Fourteen components replace the correct 2px focus ring with a 1px one

OBSERVATION	The global rule is <code>:focus-visible { outline: 2px solid hsl(var(--ring)); outline-offset: 2px }</code> — correct. Fourteen files override it with <code>focus-visible:outline-none focus-visible:ring-1</code> , including the hero CTA, the homepage CTAs and the archive filter tabs.
EVIDENCE	WCAG 2.2 SC 2.4.13 (Focus Appearance) expects a focus indicator at least 2px thick around the perimeter. A 1px gold ring on a near-black ground is at the edge of perceptible.
USER IMPACT	Keyboard users lose track of position on precisely the elements that matter most.
BUSINESS IMPACT	Accessibility exposure, and it undoes work the codebase has already done correctly.
FIX	Delete the fourteen overrides and let the global rule apply. If gold is wanted, change <code>--ring</code> once rather than per component.

10 Mobile

Mobile is where this site is weakest, and it is almost certainly where most of your prospects arrive. Beyond CA-02 and CA-04, three measured issues:

CA-15

P1

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

18.6 screens of scroll to see five projects

OBSERVATION

/portfolio measures 15,132px at 375×812. Nine major sections precede the final CTA: hero, philosophy, three featured stories, a trust marquee, the bento archive, a horizontal-scroll perspective section, four full-height quote panels, and a testimonial.

EVIDENCE

The DesignSignatures block alone contributes four full-height panels of editorial quotation containing no project imagery.

USER IMPACT

Portfolio browsing on mobile is a scanning behaviour. Nine sections of manifesto before the archive inverts the priority: the visitor came for rooms and is served philosophy.

BUSINESS IMPACT

High — drop-off compounds with every screen.

FIX

On viewports under 768px, move the bento archive directly beneath the hero and demote the four quote panels to a single condensed section. Consider collapsing the horizontal-scroll perspective section on mobile, where horizontal scroll inside vertical scroll is a known friction pattern.

CA-16

P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

38 touch targets below 44px, including the archive filters

OBSERVATION

At 375px, 38 rendered links and buttons fall below 44×44. The category filter buttons — the archive's primary discovery control — measure 32px tall.

EVIDENCE

32px clears WCAG 2.2 SC 2.5.8 (24px minimum) but falls short of both the 44px iOS and 48px Android platform guidance. The navbar hamburger, by contrast, is correctly built at 48px — the standard exists in the codebase, it is just not applied consistently.

USER IMPACT

Mis-taps on filters, which reload the grid and cost a scroll position.

BUSINESS

Moderate friction on the discovery path.

IMPACT

FIX

Set a 44px minimum on all interactive elements below md via padding, keeping the visual size unchanged where the design demands it.

11 Accessibility

The foundations are better than most sites in this category — skip links, focus trapping, reduced-motion support, alt text, semantic landmarks. The failures are specific rather than systemic.

CA-17 P2

CONFIDENCE · CERTAIN

Text at 40% white fails AA at the size it is used

OBSERVATION

text-white/40 and below appears 166 times. Against the near-black canvas it measures 3.66:1, below the 4.5:1 AA threshold for normal text.

EVIDENCE

Computed against the live ground. It is almost always applied to 10px labels — inactive filter tabs, eyebrows, meta — which cannot claim the 3:1 large-text exemption. For contrast, white/50 measures 5.28:1 and passes, and the gold accent measures 9.24:1.

USER IMPACT

Inactive filter states are hard to read for anyone in daylight or over 40 — a large share of the target client.

BUSINESS IMPACT

Compliance exposure, and it degrades navigability of the discovery controls.

FIX

Raise the floor to white/55 for any text under 18px. A single find-and-replace across the 166 occurrences, then spot-check the pages where dimness was load-bearing.

CA-18 P3

CONFIDENCE · LIKELY

Content parked at opacity 0 pending scroll observers

OBSERVATION

Scroll-reveal is used widely (useScrollReveal , GSAP, IntersectionObserver). Sections begin invisible and animate in.

EVIDENCE

Reduced-motion paths are handled, so this is not an accessibility failure. But content that starts at `opacity: 0` is invisible if the observer misfires, and the first paint of several sections is empty.

USER IMPACT

Occasional blank sections on fast scroll or slow devices.

BUSINESS
IMPACT

Low but reputationally awkward when it happens.

FIX

Animate from a visible resting state — start at `opacity: 1` and animate transform only, or add a timeout that forces visibility after ~1s.

12 Trust and conversion

Trust content exists but sits almost entirely on `/portfolio` — a `TrustLayer` marquee and a `ClientPerspective` testimonial, both roughly 12 screens deep on mobile. The homepage carries none. That is backwards: trust signals are cheapest to place where doubt first forms.

The bigger structural gap is that the site offers **three parallel entry mechanics** — the style quiz at `/aesthetic-discovery-engine`, the cost estimator at `/estimate`, and the contact form — without ever explaining how they relate or which to choose. The navbar pushes “Get Estimate”, the homepage pushes “Take Style Quiz”, the gallery pushes “Book Consultation”, and the portfolio pushes its own final CTA. Four different asks, four different labels, no stated sequence.

Recommendation (Confidence: Likely). Commit to one primary path and make the others visibly subordinate. The strongest candidate is the estimator, because a price range is the question every prospect actually has and the one no competitor answers online. Frame the quiz as an optional first step feeding into it, and the contact form as the destination both arrive at. Then use consistent language across all surfaces — if the primary action is “Get your estimate”, that phrase should appear on every page, not five variants of it.

Two credibility items are missing entirely and would cost little: the four FAQ answers already present in the homepage's `FAQPage` schema are **invisible to human visitors** — they exist only as structured data. They

answer exactly the right questions (timelines of 45–75 days, the estimate process, modular kitchen specifications). Render them. Second, there is no team page or named designer anywhere in the public routes; for a studio selling craft, anonymity is a trust cost.

13 CMS and content consistency

The media architecture described in ADR 0002 is sound — Supabase owns the record, ImageKit owns the asset, `asset_usages` mediates — and `getOptimizedUrl` is applied consistently at the point of render. The consistency risks are not in the pipeline; they are in what the presentation layer assumes about the data.

- **Aspect ratio is not owned by anyone.** Bento tiles are fixed-height with `object-cover`, so a portrait-oriented upload is centre-cropped without control. There is no focal-point field. An editor uploading a tall stairwell shot gets an arbitrary middle slice. Add a focal-point selector to the CMS, or at minimum publish an aspect-ratio guideline and validate on upload.
- **Hardcoded content masquerading as CMS content.** The homepage's featured project is a literal string and a `/public` PNG. An editor updating projects in the admin will never change it, and will reasonably assume they have.
- **Narrative fallbacks are silently wrong.** `PortfolioPage.tsx` supplies three hardcoded narratives used when `project.brief` is empty — describing a bedroom, a kitchen and an office. They are assigned by *index*, so a project without a brief inherits prose about a different room type entirely. Replace with a neutral fallback, or hide the narrative when absent.
- **Two category models.** Covered in CA-10; worth restating as a governance issue rather than a bug.

14 Ninety-day plan

WEEKS 1-2

Immediate fixes

- **CA-01** — repoint `tokens/index.css` , delete the shadow token files, tag a `checkpoint/` first, then run a full visual pass.
- **CA-03** — move the cookie panel off the hero CTA.
- **CA-02** — gate archive greyscale behind `@media (hover: hover)` ; ship colour by default.
- **CA-04** — persistent mobile WhatsApp/Call bar.
- **CA-07** — settle the brand name; fix the duplicate titles and h1s.

WEEKS 3-6

High-impact improvements

- **CA-05** — rebuild the homepage middle: services with price bands, a real CMS-driven project mosaic, one named testimonial, the FAQ answers rendered for humans.
- **CA-15** — reorder `/portfolio` on mobile so the archive precedes the manifesto.
- **CA-10** — CMS-derive portfolio categories with counts; fix the empty state.
- Put Gallery in the primary navigation and point “Explore the Gallery” at `/gallery` .
- Choose one primary conversion path and unify the CTA language across all surfaces.

WEEKS 7-10

Premium refinements

- **CA-06** — migrate to a two-token label scale; nothing actionable below 13px.
- **CA-17** and **CA-14** — contrast floor and focus-ring cleanup.
- **CA-11** — retune gallery density; add real skeletons.
- **CA-09** — CMS-controlled tile hierarchy.
- **CA-13**, **CA-16** — CTA and touch-target corrections.